



Samsung LA26R71B

A dusky beauty that's a TV too!

The smallest of Samsung's latest Bordeaux series, the Samsung LA26R71B is a 26-inch beauty: the satin-smooth, piano-black finish makes you want to keep running your fingers over the body, then frantically wiping it to get rid of fingerprints! A sleek swivel panel means you can spin it around for an all-angle view.

Once you get to focusing those over-wide retinas elsewhere, you'll notice the large, widescreen 26-inch PVA Panel. "PVA" is a Samsung patent that stands for "Patterned Vertical Alignment." Actually, PVA is Samsung lingo for MVA—Multi-domain Vertical

Alignment, one of the types of LCD panels available. This one has a whopping contrast ratio of 3000:1! The panel is HDTV-ready, and supports 720p (1280 x 720 progressively scanned) and 1080i (1920 x 1080) resolutions.

The LA26R71B can be hooked up to your PC via a 15-pin VGA connector; pity Samsung missed out on a DVI-D connector. An HDMI (High-Definition Multimedia Interface) connect is also provided. HDMI offers uncompressed audio/video that is an all-digital interface by nature, so visual and aural elements will be astoundingly clear. We watched several late-night DVD movies, not to mention hours of blissful Xbox 360 gaming on this beauty, and were, quite simply, bowled over by the visual quality. We even used a native 720p video—just amazing quality on this display.



A negative is the tacky sound, courtesy the two inbuilt 5W speakers, and seriously, if you plan to buy this display, you should include a high-end 5.1 speaker and amp setup—anything less would be criminal!

Is Rs 64,900 a bit too much for visual bliss? That's all you need to know. If you're looking for a flat TV this size, the LA26R71B will more than satisfy!

Specifications

26-inch LCD panel, 3000:1 contrast ratio, HDTV-ready, up to 1080i resolution (720p supported), outputs: HDMI, 15-pin D-Sub, 2 discrete component-ins, 10.2 Kg

Contact: Samsung Electronics India Information and Telecommunication Ltd
Phone: 011-41511234
E-mail: sabiha.k@samsung.com
Web site: www.samsung.com/in
Price: Rs 64,900

RATINGS	
Performance	★★★★★
Ease of use	★★★★★
Build quality	★★★★★
Value for money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★

Kingston K-PEX 100 2 GB

"A steal of a deal!"



The Kingston K-PEX 100 2 GB is a media player—Kingston's first such offering.

The device has USB-On-The-Go support, which lets you transfer files from a digital camera or Flash drive without a PC. It supports MP3, WMA, Ogg and WAV. Many users will be thankful for the five-band equaliser, but admittedly audio quality

is not really up to the mark when you use the bundled earphones. The highs and mids were well-reproduced, but the bass was virtually non-existent—and this means you'll have to get yourself a good pair of earphones, a la Agent001.

For video playback, the box states support for AVI, ASF, WMV, and MPEG 1 and 2, but what it does not state is that these formats are not natively supported. You need the bundled transcoder software to convert videos from these formats to the MPX format, which is the only format that sees native support on the device. After

conversion, though, the video is pleasant enough on the bright 2-inch TFT display. Photo support is limited to JPEG. The inbuilt FM player allows you to configure the signal strength: in a weak signal area, you can set it to Low, and the signal will be amplified; set it to High in strong signal areas so the signal is attenuated.

The recorder can be used to turn the K-PEX 100 into an audio recorder supporting voice and line-in sources, and

recording at 32 to 128 Kbps. You can read text files while on the move.

A 256 MB miniSD card is also included. Claimed battery life is 17 hours, and that figure is pretty accurate. All this comes for just Rs 7,050—a steal, if you will!

Specifications

2 GB, 256 MB miniSD card, 65 gm, 2-inch TFT LCD, USB-On-The-Go; music formats: MP3, WMA, Ogg, WAV; video formats: MPX, photo format: JPEG

RATINGS	
Performance	★★★★★
Features	★★★★★
Build quality	★★★★★
Value for money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★

Contact: Kingston Technology
Phone: 9820652221
E-mail: trista.wana@kingston.com.tw
Web site: www.kingston.com
Price: Rs 7,050